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dbDataInsights Geopolitics Survey

The UK's Next Political Chapter: What do Britons want?

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IMPORTANT RESEARCH DISCLOSURES LOCATED IN APPENDIX 1.

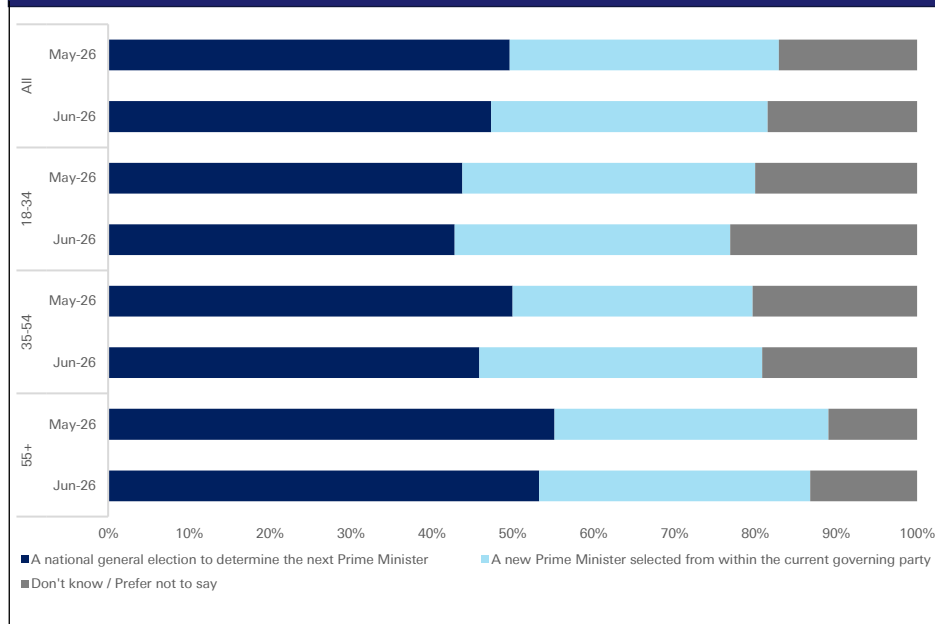
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Population would prefer election to determine the next Prime Minister



- The UK is facing yet another period of political transition. Prime Minister Starmer has announced his resignation and Starmer's successor is set to be chosen via a Labour Party leadership contest. Andy Burnham is the overwhelming favourite, having returned to Westminster following his victory in last month's Makerfield by-election. Thus far, no Labour MPs have announced their intention to run against Burnham.
- **Our survey data indicates that almost half of all respondents want a General Election** to determine the next PM, with older voters most in favour, compared with 34% supporting the selection of a new PM via an internal Labour Party contest. This sentiment is particularly salient as PM Starmer is currently only one of the last five PMs to have entered Downing Street as a result of a general election victory.
- While the opposition has not yet called for an election, **pressure will likely ramp up** if the new PM significantly deviates from Labour's 2024 Manifesto (though the size of Labour's majority and uncertain polling have raised the bar for an early election) and based on specific policies like defence spending or the economy.
- Both Keir Starmer, as Prime Minister, and Andy Burnham, should he become PM, operate within a tightly constrained environment defined by pre-election promises, a sobering economic reality, and restless internal party dynamics.

Support for yet another leadership transfer or national election?



Methodology

These results are derived from a monthly online nationally representative survey of ~550 respondents in the UK. Our protocol ensures proportional representation across key demographics such as age, income, location, and gender to accurately reflect population diversity. Participants are restricted from taking the survey more than once every six months. The geopolitics questions are integrated into a larger monthly survey conducted by the dbDataInsights team.

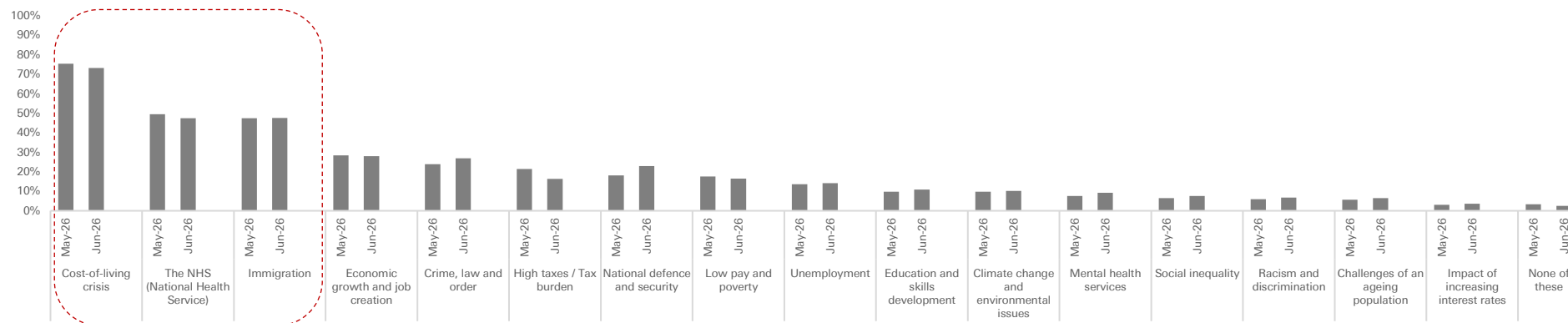
Source: dbDataInsights

Responses collected in June 2026 from an Online Nationally Representative sample of ~550 UK respondents.

Voters Speak: Defining the New Prime Minister's Core Mission



The New PM's Top Priorities



- The message from the electorate is loud and unequivocally clear: an overwhelming 73% of respondents, with remarkable consistency across every demographic and income band, demand that **the cost-of-living crisis be the new Prime Minister's absolute and immediate priority**. This unified call underscores the urgency and widespread concern that must now define the leadership's agenda.
- Andy Burnham has already promised action, stating that if successful, he would seek to reduce bills in areas such as energy, water and transport through increased public control. However, we note that many current cost pressures on essential goods and services (namely, energy and food) are driven by broader global volatility, including escalating trade tensions, persistent tariff pressures and military conflicts. Such external factors inevitably translate into significant impacts on household purchasing power and overall consumer sentiment domestically.
- Beyond economic pressures, the **National Health Service** also stands out as a significant immediate focus, identified by 47% of respondents – a reflection of an ageing society. This highlights a widespread public expectation that the health service requires urgent attention and resources beyond the multi-billion pound investment delivered thus far.
- Demographic-specific priorities are evident within the survey results. A notable **55% of the oldest age cohort surveyed identified immigration** as a key issue requiring the attention of the new PM. **28% of the youngest age group want to see focus on addressing unemployment** (vs. just 3% of the oldest group), likely reflecting the UK's high levels of youth unemployment and persistent fears over the impact of AI on entry-level jobs.

Source: dbDataInsights

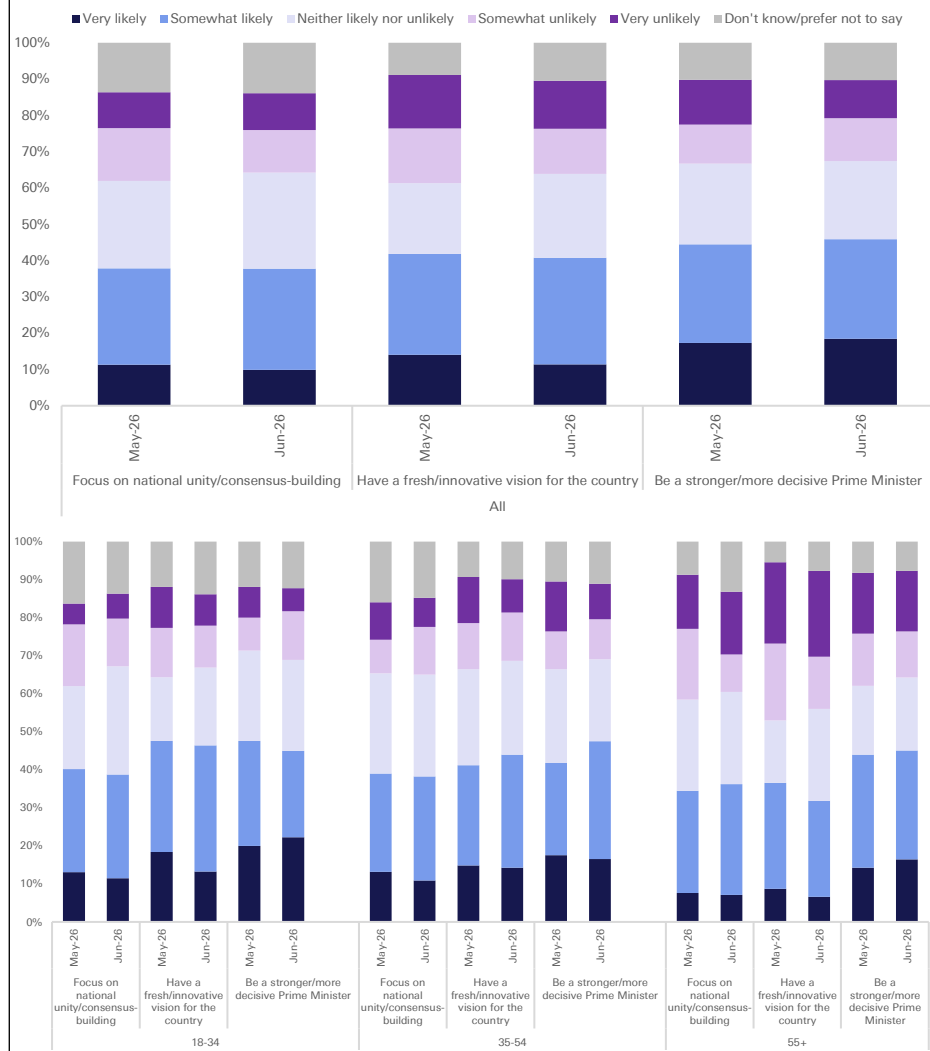
Responses collected in June 2026 from an Online Nationally Representative sample of ~550 UK respondents. See slide one for further information.

New PM, New Hope: Voters Expect a Different Approach and Vision



- A significant **46% of respondents anticipate a more decisive leader in the new PM**. This expectation suggests voters are looking for an administration that will implement its agenda with greater resolve, contrasting with past instances where initiatives faced alterations or reversals after public and Labour MP resistance.
- Approximately 41% of respondents anticipate the new PM is likely to pursue a **fresh or innovative vision for the country**. This sentiment is particularly pronounced among higher-income demographics, with 52% of those earning £50k+ expecting to see a new approach.
- Meanwhile, expectations that the new PM's strategy will represent a marked innovation appears to diminish with age, suggesting **younger cohorts are more optimistic about a fresh start**.
- 38% of respondents believe it is likely that the new PM will focus on **national unity / consensus building**. Given current fiscal constraints, we note that there will be a delicate balance between delivering positive change and avoiding reforms which could prove politically / electorally unpalatable.

Leadership Reset: What Voters Expect from the New PM



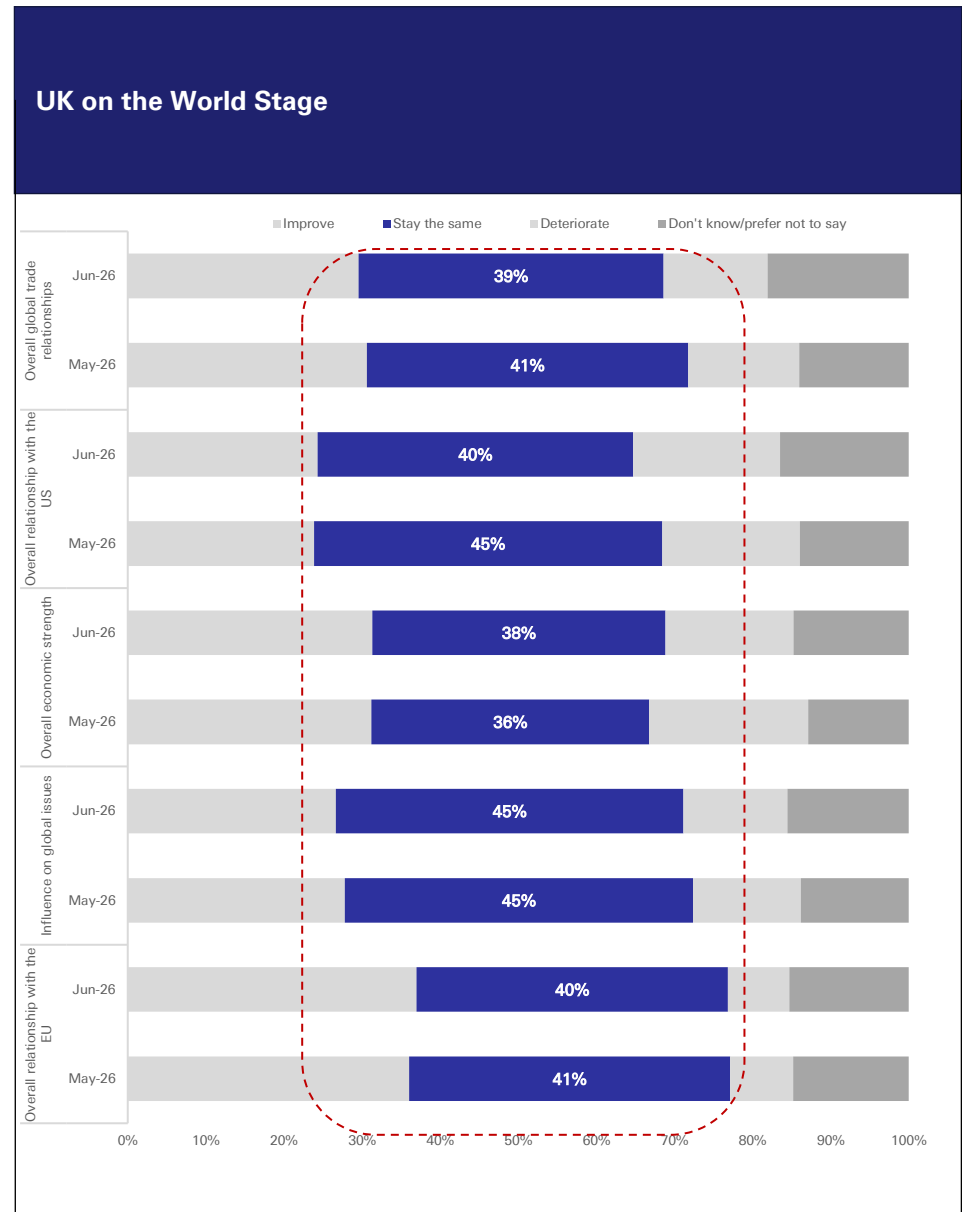
Source: dbDataInsights

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Perception Shift? Guarded Optimism for the New PM's Impact



- 36% of respondents reported **feeling more optimistic about the overall future of the UK** as a result of a new Prime Minister being set to take office, with younger cohorts feeling particularly strongly (47% of 18–34 year-olds reported feeling more optimistic).
- On an international level, the public mood appears more guarded, with 45% of survey participants believing that the UK's **influence on global issues is set to remain the same**, perhaps indicating a perception that international relations are more deeply entrenched or less amenable to rapid positive change, regardless of a new Prime Minister's efforts.
- Respondents are split on the **trajectory of the UK's relationship with the US** under the new PM, with 24% expecting an improvement compared with 19% who foresee a deterioration.
- However, there is **greater optimism over the UK's relationship with the EU**, with 37% expecting this to get better compared with only 8% who believe it will get worse.
- The highest income group (£50k+) appears most optimistic that the new PM will see an improvement to the UK's international positioning and its relationships with key allies, while the oldest age cohort displays the greatest degree of caution.



Source: dbDataInsights

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Appendix 1



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